



RELOCATION GUIDE

Bundaberg

Taribelang Bunda, Gooreng Gooreng, Gurang and Bailai Country

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Bundaberg.

Fifteen minutes to the beach. The reef just offshore.

Bundaberg is a sunny river city in southern Queensland, ringed by canefields, with the Coral Coast a short drive east and the southernmost islands of the Great Barrier Reef on the horizon. Its health service is growing with one of regional Queensland's fastest-growing catchments, and a family home near the water is a realistic plan on a single clinical income.

~104,000

people across the
Bundaberg region

15 min

to the beaches at
Bargara

~4 hrs

by road to Brisbane, or
about an hour by air

Nov–Mar

turtle season at Mon
Repos

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Bundaberg

Most people who move here are trading a bigger city for warm weather, a commute measured in minutes and a beach that is never far away. It is a trade people tend to be very glad they made.



If you're looking for big-city range and a large subspecialty department, Bundaberg may not be it. If you're drawn to sunshine, real clinical responsibility and turtles on the beach in summer, it could be a wonderful choice.

Bundaberg sits on the Burnett River about fifteen kilometres inland, roughly four hours north of Brisbane, in the Wide Bay–Burnett region. Around a hundred thousand people live across the wider council area, in the city itself and in the coastal towns of Bargara, Burnett Heads, Innes Park and Elliott Heads. Sugar built the place, and it still shapes the landscape, the calendar and the city's two famous drinks: Bundaberg Rum and Bundaberg ginger beer.

For clinicians, the attraction is a regional health service that is **growing faster than the city around it**. The public hospital is the referral centre for a catchment of well over two hundred thousand people, and a major new hospital is being built on the city's southern side. That means broad, varied work, a team that knows each other's names, and a real chance to grow with a service as it expands.

Then there is the life around the work. A ten- or fifteen-minute commute, free parking, a subtropical winter most of Australia envies, and the southern Great Barrier Reef close enough for a day trip. Bundaberg is one of the closest cities in Australia to the reef, and that is what keeps people here long after the job stops being new.

WHAT YOU GAIN

Real responsibility, quickly

A busy, growing regional service means broader day-to-day scope and earlier access to complex work than a big-city rotation.

Hours back every day

Most of the city sits ten to fifteen minutes from work, wherever you choose to live.

A home that leaves room

Housing costs a fraction of Brisbane or the southern capitals, so a family home near the water is realistic on one clinical income.

The reef and the rookery

Turtles at Mon Repos every summer and coral cays offshore, without the far-north crowds.

GOOD TO KNOW

A close-knit specialist team

Departments are smaller than in Brisbane. Ask how many colleagues sit alongside you in your own specialty.

Brisbane for tertiary care

The rarest and most complex cases go south to Brisbane or the Sunshine Coast, as they do across regional Queensland.

A proper summer

November to March is hot, humid and stormy. Locals plan around it with early swims, air-conditioning and long, lazy afternoons.

A regional city

The amenities of a growing regional centre rather than a capital. Many people find that a relief; Brisbane is there for a big weekend away.

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Weighing up your options?

People often compare Bundaberg with Brisbane, for subspecialty depth, and the Gold Coast, for beaches with a big city's services behind them. Both are close enough that Bundaberg can be a first move rather than a final one, and plenty of people who come for two years are still here a decade later. We are happy to talk any of them through.



A quiet boardwalk to the beach on Bundaberg's Coral Coast



Evenings and weekends at the beach become part of ordinary family life

A river city in cane country, with the coast next door

Bundaberg is easiest to understand as a river city surrounded by cane, with the coast a short, deliberate drive away. Almost everything about the place follows from that.

The city centre and the older suburbs sit close to the Burnett River, with heritage streets, shady parks and the riverside walking paths. Canefields ring the city on three sides. Fifteen minutes east is the coast: Bargara with its headland and rock pools, Burnett Heads and the port to the north, Innes Park and Elliott Heads to the south. Newer suburbs have grown out towards the coast and along the highway corridors.

Bundaberg is the main service centre for the region, with the hospital, a university campus, TAFE, a regional airport with flights to Brisbane, and a stop on the Brisbane–Cairns rail line. Hervey Bay and K'gari are an hour and a half south, and Agnes Water and the Town of 1770 a similar distance north.



The Burnett Bridge and the city centre on the river



The headland at Bargara, a quarter of an hour from town

Summer

DEC – FEB

Hot and humid, around 29–31°C by day, with afternoon storms and the heaviest rain of the year. Turtle season is in full swing at Mon Repos.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Warm and gradually drier, around 25–29°C. Many locals' favourite time for the beach and the reef.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Mild, dry and sunny, around 22–23°C by day with cool mornings. The cane crushing season gets under way and humpback whales pass offshore.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Warming up, around 25–28°C, and one of the driest stretches of the year before the summer storms build.



Taribelang Bunda, Gooreng Gooreng, Gurang and Bailai Country

FOR TENS OF THOUSANDS OF YEARS

The Burnett River and the surrounding coast have been lived on and cared for by these peoples since long before European arrival.



A township on the Burnett

1870

European settlement followed the river, and the town grew around the farmland beside it.



Sugar and the mills

1880S ONWARD

Cane mills and the tramlines that served them shaped the city's economy, and still work today.



Rum from molasses

1888

Distilling began to use the sugar mills' surplus molasses, and grew into one of Australia's best-known drinks.



A regional health and service hub

TODAY

Bundaberg anchors health, retail and education for a growing region, with a major new hospital under construction.



A note on Country

Bundaberg sits on the Country of the Taribelang Bunda, Gooreng Gooreng, Gurang and Bailai peoples. An Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings and events across the region, and you will soon find it a natural part of working life.

Healthcare in Bundaberg

Bundaberg's health service is growing faster than its population, because the wider region it serves is one of the fastest-growing corners of regional Queensland. That trajectory is the part most people underestimate.

Public hospital and community health services are run by the state's regional public health service for the Wide Bay. The city's public hospital is the referral centre for Bundaberg, the Fraser Coast, North Burnett and the Discovery Coast, a combined catchment of more than two hundred and twenty-five thousand people that the state expects to keep growing for decades. It carries emergency, acute medicine and surgery, maternity, paediatrics, intensive care, mental health, imaging and cancer care.

A **major new hospital is being built at Thabeban**, on the city's southern side, adding beds, operating theatres, a larger emergency department, acute mental health and diagnostic capacity. Private hospitals, specialist practices and private imaging services work alongside the public system, and general practice and community health reach out into the surrounding towns. The most complex cases are referred to Brisbane or the Sunshine Coast.



A busy regional service: broad work, and a team that knows each other's names

225,000+

people in the wider catchment

Bundaberg, the Fraser Coast, North Burnett and the Discovery Coast

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major new hospital on the way

among regional Queensland's largest health projects

~4 hrs

to Brisbane's tertiary centres

or about an hour by air

CAPABLE GENERALISTS

Broad scope

You see a wide case mix and make more of the decisions yourself than you would in a metropolitan subspecialty post.

A ONCE-IN-A-CAREER BUILD

Growing with the service

A chance to help shape a service as new capacity comes online, rather than joining one that is already settled.

REAL BREADTH

Imaging and radiation

Varied work across modalities, with a rural and coastal case mix a city department would not see in the same proportions.

VISIBILITY

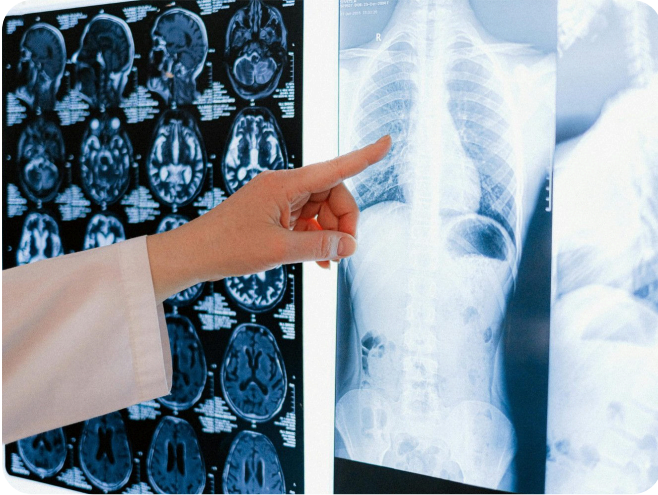
Real progression

People step into senior, teaching and leadership roles sooner than they might in a large centre.

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How pay works here

Registration with Ahpra is national, but pay is set state by state. In Queensland's public system salaries come from the industrial agreement for your profession, so the same role can sit on a different scale elsewhere. Private-sector pay is negotiated individually. Regional roles can also come with relocation support and incentives; ask us what applies to yours.



Imaging is one of the most exciting areas of a growing regional service



Teams here are close, and new colleagues are welcomed in quickly

What to ask at interview

- ☐ How will the new hospital change my role and my team, and when?
- ☐ How many colleagues sit alongside me in my own specialty?
- ☐ Which cases go to Brisbane or the Sunshine Coast, and how is that handled day to day?
- ☐ What is the on-call pattern, and how often is it actually called on?
- ☐ Which modalities or sub-specialties would I cover, and is cross-training supported?
- ☐ What CPD time and funding is there, and does it cover travel to Brisbane?
- ☐ What orientation and supervision is offered to clinicians new to Australia?

Where to live in Bundaberg

Bundaberg is compact enough that most commutes stay under fifteen minutes, so you can choose on lifestyle rather than logistics. The real decision is coastal, central or the rural fringe.

~15–20 MIN · THE BEACH

Bargara & Innes Park

The coastal choice, with newer homes, the esplanade, cafés and rock pools. Popular with families and a growing retiree community.

WALKABLE · RIVER

City centre & North Bundaberg

Heritage streets and timber Queenslanders close to the river, cafés and the CBD. Ideal if you like to walk to dinner.

~10 MIN · BETWEEN

Kalkie & Ashfield

Family suburbs halfway between town and the coast, with easy access both ways and plenty of newer housing.

~10 MIN · CENTRAL

Avenell Heights, Norville & Millbank

Established, central suburbs close to schools, shops and the CBD. Good value and very easy living.

~5 MIN · SOUTH SIDE

Thabeban & Svensson Heights

Close to the new hospital site on the southern side of the city, and practical for shift work.

~20–25 MIN · QUIET COAST

Elliott Heads & Coral Cove

South along the coast, quieter again than Bargara, with the river mouth for fishing and paddling.

~20–25 MIN · NORTH COAST

Burnett Heads & Moore Park Beach

Relaxed seaside villages near the port and Mon Repos, with long beaches and a slower pace.

RUBYANNA · BRANYAN · QUNABA

The rural fringe

Larger blocks and cane-country views for people who want space. A car is essential.

Before you look at a single listing, fix your work site. The new hospital is being built at Thabeban on the southern side of the city, while other clinics and services are more central. Nothing here is a long drive, but knowing whether you face five minutes or twenty is worth it before you sign a lease.

Almost everyone we place rents for six to twelve months before buying, and that works well here too. The region's growth keeps good rentals in demand, so having something secured for your first month takes the pressure off while you find the street you love.



A classic Queenslander: deep verandas made for warm evenings



Timber cottages on stumps are a familiar sight in Queensland's older suburbs

Practical, in order

- ☐ Fix your work site before you choose a suburb.
- ☐ Decide between coastal, central or the rural fringe.
- ☐ Rent for the first six to twelve months, and secure something before you fly.
- ☐ Ask about air-conditioning, ceiling fans and screens; they make summer far more comfortable.
- ☐ Check the council's flood mapping for any address near the river or low-lying coast.
- ☐ If schools matter, check the catchment for the exact address before you sign.

Getting around Bundaberg

Short drives, easy parking and quiet roads. A car is the way most people get around, and it earns its keep on the coast and the weekend day trips as much as the commute.

Most trips across Bundaberg take ten to fifteen minutes, and parking is generally easy and often free: a real change if you are arriving from London, Johannesburg, Dubai or a capital city. A local bus network runs across the city under Translink, with tickets bought on board, but its timetable is not built around shift work, so most clinicians drive.

For a two-adult household, plan on two cars once you are settled; some families manage on one for the first year if only one partner is commuting. The regional used-car market is smaller than a capital's, so it is worth starting your search early.

~15 min

most trips across the city

~4 hrs

to Brisbane by road

~1 hr

flight to Brisbane

~15 MIN FROM THE CBD

By air

The regional airport has direct flights to Brisbane, the quickest way south and the link for international travel.

BRISBANE-CAIRNS LINE

By rail

Regional and Tilt Train services call at Bundaberg. Slower than flying, and a relaxing alternative to the drive.

THE BRUCE HIGHWAY

By road

About four hours to Brisbane. A normal weekend trip if you plan around it, with coaches running the corridor too.

TRANSLINK REGIONAL NETWORK

City buses

Local routes across the city; handy for older children and days without the car.

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
Across the city	10-15 min
City → airport	~10 min

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
City → Bargara	~15 min
City → Mon Repos	~15–20 min
City → Elliott Heads	~20–25 min
City → Childers	~45 min
City → Hervey Bay	~1 hr 30
City → Agnes Water & 1770	~1 hr 45
City → Brisbane	~4 hrs 15



A Queensland country road at sunrise: weekend drives are part of regional life

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Your licence

Converting an overseas licence, registering a car and insurance work the same way across Queensland and are set out on the Queensland Government's transport pages. Drive your commute once at your real start time, especially from the coast, before you commit to an address.

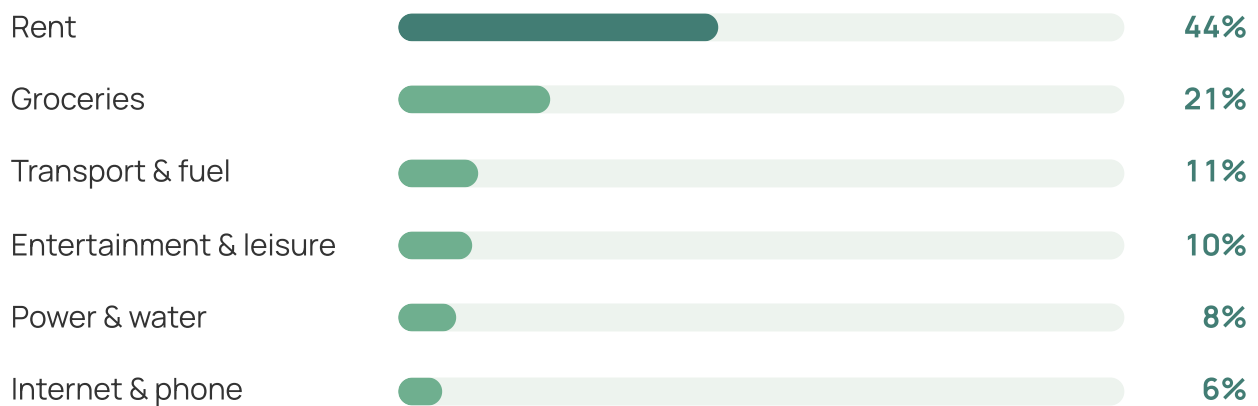
What it costs to live here

Housing is the whole story. Most everyday costs sit close to the Queensland average, while a roof over your head costs far less than in Brisbane or the southern capitals.

Queensland public-sector pay is set statewide, so a clinician on a given step earns the same in Bundaberg as in Brisbane. What changes is what that salary carries. Rents and house prices here are a fraction of the capital's, and **a family home near the water is achievable on a single clinical income** in a way it is not in most of coastal Australia. Over a career, that difference compounds.

Groceries, fuel, insurance, power, phone and internet sit close to the state-wide level; Bundaberg is big enough to have real competition, so there is no regional penalty on the weekly shop. Two costs quietly disappear when you leave a capital: parking and a long commute.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is still the biggest line, but here it takes a noticeably smaller share than in Brisbane.

Worth planning for

- ✓ Two cars, eventually. Most households run two once they are settled; it is still far less than the commuting and parking costs of a capital.
- ✓ Flights beyond Brisbane. Most domestic and all international trips connect through Brisbane, so allow for that leg.
- ✓ Summer cooling. Air-conditioning in the warmer months shows up on the power bill, so a home with good fans, shade and solar is worth seeking out.
- ✓ The first-year setup. Visa and registration fees, flights, a car, furniture and a rental bond are the same wherever you land; plan for them early.



Your salary goes noticeably further in regional Queensland

IN SHORT

- ✓ Think of Bundaberg as Queensland prices with a much more affordable home.
- ✓ On a clinical salary you can live comfortably and often buy a family home years sooner than in a capital.
- ✓ Check current listings for the suburbs you like, and ask us what a role pays before you model anything.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Bundaberg

Bundaberg is one of those places people rarely plan for and then fall for completely. Candidates come to me expecting a quiet cane town, and a year later they are sending me photos of turtle hatchlings at Mon Repos, their kids in the rock pools at Bargara and a house they never imagined they could own.

What I love most is the timing. A service that is building a brand-new hospital is a service that will remember the people who helped it grow, and the clinicians who arrive now get to shape what it becomes. My one tip: visit in summer if you can, so you know the warmth and the storms, then picture the dry, blue winter that follows. If that sounds like your kind of life, Bundaberg could be a wonderful home.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



A Queensland sunset: the long, warm evenings people move here for

Food, markets and the everyday

Bundaberg sits in one of Queensland's great food-growing regions, and it shows. Fresh local produce is the centre of the week, and the beach is never far from it.

Alongside the cane, the Bundaberg region grows a remarkable share of the country's macadamias, sweet potatoes, avocados, tomatoes and other fruit and vegetables. The weekend markets reflect it: genuinely fresh, genuinely local, and good value enough that cooking at home becomes a pleasure rather than a chore.

Eating out is better than the city's size might suggest, with fresh seafood, a café scene that has grown noticeably around the CBD and Bargara, and good pub dining. The range is narrower than Brisbane's, so for a particular cuisine you may cook it yourself or save it for a trip south. The city's Asian and international grocers and its growing Indian, Filipino and Nepali communities make that much easier than it used to be.

FRESH AND LOCAL

Sunday markets

Fruit, vegetables, eggs and bread straight from the growers, then on to the coast.

LOCAL ICONS

The distillery and the brewery

Tours of the historic rum distillery and the ginger-beer barrel make a fun first weekend.

CAFÉS BY THE SEA

Bargara's esplanade

Breakfast, fish and chips and sunset drinks with a view of the water.

WALKS AND COFFEE

The riverside

The Burnett River foreshore paths and cafés make an easy evening stroll.



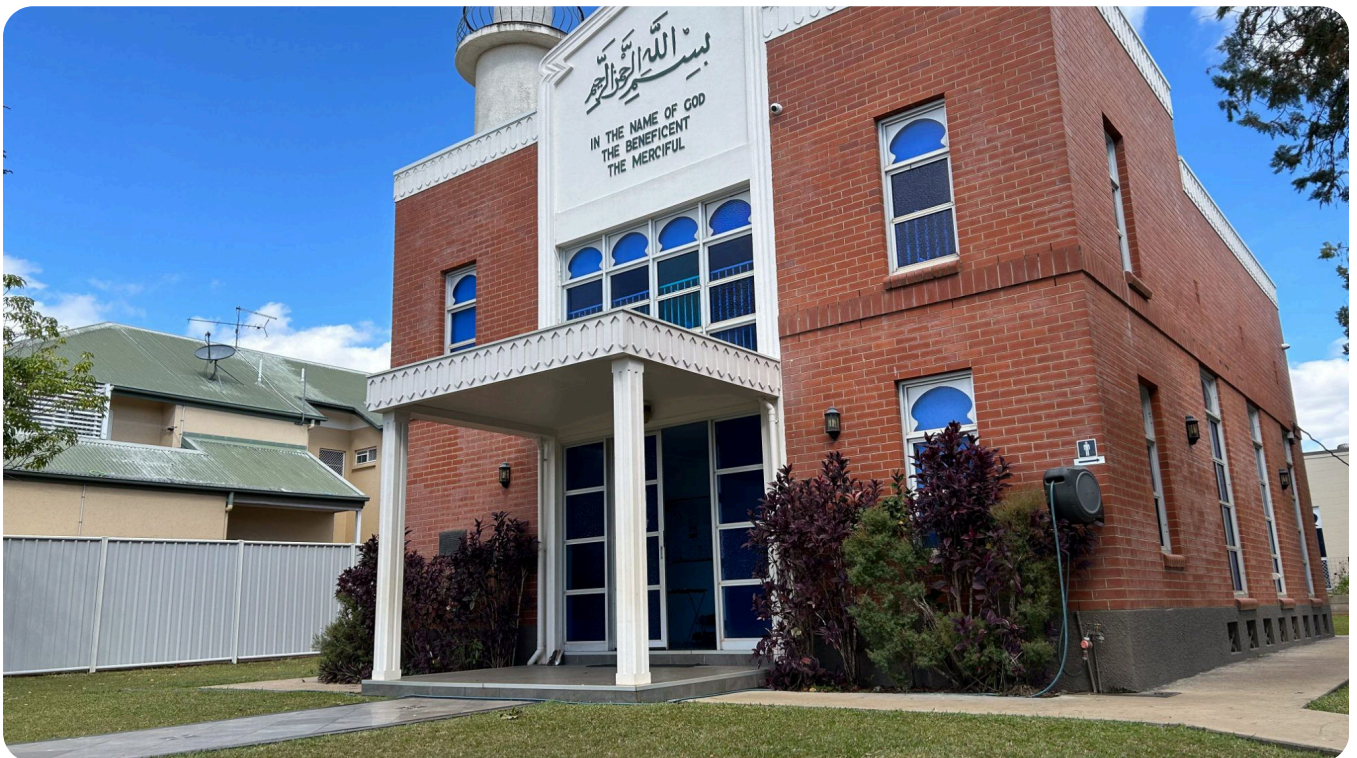
Fresh produce from the region turns shared meals into a weekly habit



Café brunch and fresh seafood: the café scene has grown well

A week, once the novelty has worn off

- ✓ Weekdays: a short commute, and enough light left for a swim or a walk at Bargara after work.
- ✓ Saturday: sport, errands and the beach, depending on the tide and the mood.
- ✓ Sunday: the markets first, then the coast, or a reef day when the weather is kind.
- ✓ Turtle season, November to March: an evening at Mon Repos becomes a family ritual you repeat every year.



Mareeba Mosque on the Atherton Tablelands: settled faith communities are part of regional Queensland life, Bundaberg included

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Finding your people

Bundaberg is small enough that joining something is the fastest way in: a surf club, a cricket or netball team, a parents' committee, a church or a cultural association. The Malayali, Indian, Filipino and Nepali communities are active and welcoming, and clinicians tell us the professional community here is unusually close. Our local directory lists groups to contact before you arrive.

What people do at the weekend

This is the part of Bundaberg that needs the least explaining: beaches fifteen minutes away, a nationally important turtle rookery down the road, and the southern Great Barrier Reef a day trip offshore.

Weekends start at the coast. Bargara has calm swimming beaches, coral rock pools to snorkel at low tide, and a lovely esplanade walk along the basalt headland. Mon Repos, just north, is the largest loggerhead turtle rookery on the Australian mainland: from November to March, rangers lead small evening groups to watch turtles nest and hatchlings make their run for the sea. Bookings open through Queensland Parks and Wildlife, and they go fast.

When the weather is kind, the reef is the big day out. Lady Musgrave Island, a coral cay with a lagoon you can snorkel, is a day cruise from the Port of Bundaberg, and Lady Elliot Island, famous for manta rays and turtles, is a short scenic flight from the city's airport. This is reef without the far-north crowds.

~15 MIN · BEACH & ROCK POOLS

Bargara

Swimming, snorkelling the rock pools at low tide, and the esplanade at sunset.

~15–20 MIN · NOV–MAR

Mon Repos

Ranger-guided turtle encounters at night in season, and a lovely beach walk any time of year.

~20–25 MIN · RIVER & BEACH

Elliott Heads

Fishing, paddling and quiet swimming where the Elliott River meets the sea.

DAY CRUISE · PORT OF BUNDABERG

Lady Musgrave Island

A coral cay and lagoon on the southern Great Barrier Reef, with snorkelling straight off the pontoon.

SHORT SCENIC FLIGHT

Lady Elliot Island

Manta rays, turtles and clear water, for a day trip or a few nights at the island eco-resort.

~25 MIN · LONG SANDY BEACH

Moore Park Beach

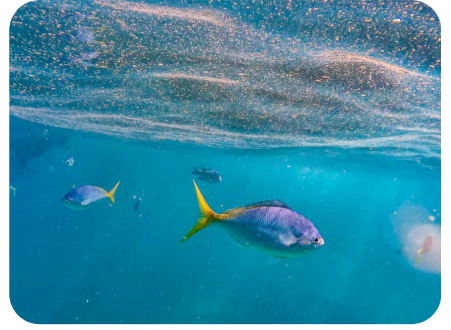
Kilometres of quiet sand north of the river mouth, ideal for long walks and family picnics.



A turtle over tropical coral: the kind of encounter the southern reef islands are loved for



A tropical coral garden in Queensland waters



Snorkelling over a reef on a calm day

In the city itself

- ✓ A tour of the historic rum distillery, and a visit to the home of Bundaberg's ginger beer.
- ✓ The Bundaberg Botanic Gardens, with the Hinkler Hall of Aviation celebrating the city's pioneering aviator.
- ✓ Baldwin Swamp wetlands, a short walk from the centre, for birdwatching.
- ✓ Walking and cycling paths along the Burnett River.
- ✓ Sunday markets and seasonal festivals.
- ✓ A drive through the canefields in crushing season.

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**You get the reef without the queue,
and the turtles without the tour bus.**

Around Bundaberg

Bundaberg sits in the middle of some of Queensland's loveliest coast: the Discovery Coast to the north, Hervey Bay and K'gari to the south, and the southern Great Barrier Reef offshore.

North, Agnes Water and the Town of 1770 sit on the Discovery Coast, where Queensland's northernmost surf beach meets national parks and the place where Captain Cook's party came ashore in 1770. South, Hervey Bay is one of the best places in the world to watch humpback whales from July to October, and the ferry across to K'gari, the largest sand island on Earth, makes for an unforgettable long weekend of freshwater lakes, rainforest and endless beach driving.

Inland, Childers is a pretty heritage town in macadamia and avocado country. Brisbane is about four hours down the Bruce Highway or an hour by air, for big shopping, concerts, sport and international flights. For snow, Queenslanders fly south: the New South Wales Snowy Mountains and the Victorian Alps are a short flight from Brisbane and an easy winter holiday.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
The nearest beach (Bargara)	~15 min	Calm swimming, rock pools to snorkel and the esplanade. Swim between the flags at patrolled beaches.
Ski fields (Snowy Mountains or Victorian Alps)	a flight via Brisbane	Fly to Sydney, Canberra or Melbourne and drive on; a favourite winter holiday from June to September, snow permitting.
Brisbane (nearest city)	~4 hrs drive · ~1 hr flight	The state capital: tertiary medicine, big shopping, concerts, sport and international flights.
Bundaberg Airport	~10 min	Direct flights to Brisbane, and scenic flights to Lady Elliot Island.
Mon Repos	~15–20 min	Australia's largest mainland loggerhead turtle rookery; ranger-led encounters November to March.
Lady Musgrave & Lady Elliot Islands	day cruise or short flight	The southernmost coral cays of the Great Barrier Reef, with lagoons, turtles and manta rays.
Agnes Water & the Town of 1770	~1 hr 45	Surf lessons, national parks, sunset over the water and a relaxed beach-town weekend.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Hervey Bay & K'gari	~1 hr 30 + ferry	Whale watching from July to October, and the World Heritage sand island across the strait.
Childers	~45 min	A heritage main street, galleries and cafés in the heart of macadamia and avocado country.



Brisbane, the state capital, about four hours south by road or an hour by air

~1 HR 45 · DISCOVERY COAST

Agnes Water & 1770

Learn to surf, kayak the creek and stay for sunset; Lady Musgrave cruises also leave from 1770.

~1 HR 30 · WHALE SEASON

Hervey Bay

A long, calm, family-friendly bay with a famous pier and some of the world's best whale watching.

FERRY FROM RIVER HEADS

K'gari

Lake McKenzie, rainforest walks and the 75 Mile Beach; book a tour or take a 4WD.

~45 MIN · HERITAGE TOWN

Childers

A handsome old main street, local produce and a pleasant Sunday drive through farm country.



Calm-water paddling: a favourite way to spend a still Queensland morning



Brisbane's Story Bridge: the big city is there whenever you want a weekend away



Surf days: Agnes Water is Queensland's northernmost surf beach



It is never too late to learn to surf on a warm coast



Camping weekends are a big part of Queensland life



Koalas in a eucalypt: a favourite with visiting families



A red kangaroo on the open plains: Queensland's outback is there for a longer road trip

Families and schools

Bundaberg is a relaxed, outdoor place to raise children: beaches and rock pools on the doorstep, sport everywhere, short school runs and turtles every summer.



Learning to surf and to swim early are part of growing up on the coast



Calm, shallow Queensland water is perfect for little swimmers

Queensland schooling starts with Prep, a full-time year children begin when they turn five by 30 June. Primary school runs from Prep to Year 6 and secondary from Year 7 to Year 12, across four terms, finishing with the Queensland Certificate of Education (QCE).

Most children attend state schools run by the Queensland Department of Education. Bundaberg has a good spread of state primary and secondary schools, including long-established Bundaberg State High School, alongside Catholic schools such as Shalom College and independent schools such as St Luke's Anglican School and Bundaberg Christian College, which charge fees. State schools have catchment areas, so check the catchment for the exact address before you sign a lease.

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School fees for temporary visa holders

Queensland generally enrolls the children of skilled employer-sponsored visa holders (such as the 482 and 494) in state schools without tuition fees, while some other temporary visas are fee-paying. Confirm your visa subclass with the Department of Education's international unit (DE International), which publishes the schedule of visa subclasses and enrolment conditions. School levies, uniforms and excursions still apply.

What children tend to love here

- ✓ Watching hatchlings run for the sea at Mon Repos in summer.
- ✓ Nippers (junior surf lifesaving) at the local surf clubs.
- ✓ The Botanic Gardens, the aviation museum and riverside playgrounds.
- ✓ Rock-pool snorkelling at Bargara at low tide.
- ✓ Club sport, from football, rugby league and netball to swimming and cricket.
- ✓ A first reef trip to Lady Musgrave or Lady Elliot Island.



After the bell: outdoor play suits the warm climate



Weekends on the water start young

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Early childhood

Queensland funds free kindy, up to 15 hours a week, in approved kindergarten programmes in the year before Prep. Long day care and family day care are available across the city; many families on temporary visas are not eligible for the federal Child Care Subsidy, so ask about fees and waitlists early.

BUNDABERG CAMPUS

CQUniversity

A regional university campus offering degrees including nursing, education and health-related study.

BUNDABERG CAMPUS

TAFE Queensland

Vocational training and free English classes through the Adult Migrant English Program.

FRASER COAST CAMPUS · HERVEY BAY

University of the Sunshine Coast

A further option within commuting distance for some courses.

~4 HRS OR A SHORT FLIGHT

Brisbane's universities

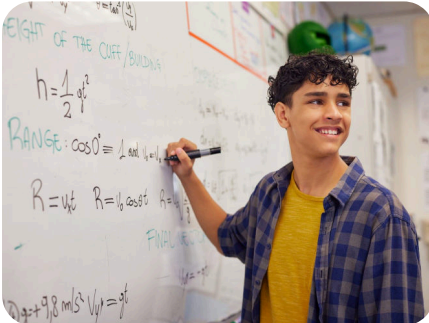
The state's large research universities, for older children who want the big-city campus experience.



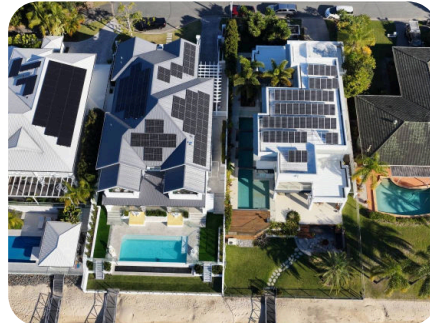
Free kindy runs in the year before Prep



Play-based learning is at the heart of early childhood in Australia



Secondary school ends with the Queensland Certificate of Education



Queensland homes are built for outdoor living, with pools, shade and solar



Hill Inlet and Whitehaven Beach in the Whitsundays: a classic Queensland family holiday further north

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Come for the growing service; stay for the turtles, the reef and the long, warm afternoons.

Your Bundaberg address book

Bundaberg is a friendly regional city with small, close communities that are quick to welcome newcomers. The Malayali community has its own association of more than ninety families and a Syro-Malabar Catholic mission, and you will also find active Indian, Filipino and Nepali associations, a Coptic Orthodox church and a long-standing mosque. For a wider choice of temples, gurdwaras and specialist groceries, Brisbane is an easy weekend away.

COUNCILS & LOCAL SERVICES

Bundaberg Regional Council

Rubbish and recycling, libraries, parks, pools, pet registration, events and flood mapping for the region

1300 883 699 bundaberg.qld.gov.au

Bundaberg Region tourism

Turtle season, reef trips, markets and things to do across the region

bundabergregion.org

Queensland Parks and Wildlife Service

Bookings for the Mon Repos Turtle Encounter and national park camping

parks.qld.gov.au

GETTING AROUND & HEALTH ADVICE

Translink

Bundaberg's city bus timetables and the Queensland journey planner

13 12 30 translink.com.au

13 HEALTH

Queensland's 24/7 health advice line, staffed by registered nurses

13 43 25 84 qld.gov.au/health

Queensland Government

Driver licences, vehicle registration, schools and state services in one place

qld.gov.au

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Bundaberg Indian Malayali Association (BIMA)

Kerala cultural association of more than ninety Malayali families, with Onam, Christmas and community events through the year.

facebook.com/p/Bundaberg-Indian-Malaylee-Association-100083543163914

Indian Association of Bundaberg

Multicultural activities, community support and yoga, based in Kalkie; a good first contact for Indian festivals in the city.

Bundaberg and District Australian Filipino Association

Social, cultural and welfare group for the Filipino-Australian community, with regular gatherings and an annual Philippine Independence Day celebration. Based at 111 Targo Street.

Bundaberg Nepalese Community

Community group for people of Nepali origin and their friends, with cultural celebrations and social events.

Bundaberg & District Neighbourhood Centre

Migrant settlement support (information, referrals and community connection), adult literacy and numeracy, and other community programmes, at 111 Targo Street.

07 4153 1614

bundabergneighbourhoodcentre.org.au

Adult Migrant English Program (TAFE Queensland)

Free English classes for eligible migrants, delivered at TAFE Queensland's Bundaberg campus.

tafeqld.edu.au/amep

PLACES OF WORSHIP

Catholic Parish of Bundaberg

Catholic parish with several churches across the city, including the Church of the Holy Rosary in the centre; Mass times are on the parish website.

07 4151 6666 bundabergcatholic.net.au

Syro-Malabar Catholic Mission, Bundaberg

Syro-Malabar Catholic community in Bundaberg, part of the Eparchy of St Thomas the Apostle, Melbourne; check the website for Malayalam Mass times.

syromalabar.org.au/bundaberg

Anglican Parish of Bundaberg

Christ Church beside Buss Park in the city centre, with St Peter's at Bargara and St John the Divine at Burnett Heads.

bundaberganglican.org

Heritage Christian Centre (Pentecostal)

Pentecostal church affiliated with the Australian Christian Churches, at 58 Woondooma Street, with Sunday services and campuses in Gin Gin and Childers.

heritagecc.com.au

St Mary & St Moses Coptic Orthodox Church

Coptic Orthodox church serving the Wide Bay region, at 31 Kensington Street, Norville, with liturgies, Sunday school and youth meetings.

widebaycopts.org.au

Bundaberg Mosque (Bundaberg Turkish and Islamic Society)

The city's mosque on Hanbury Street, serving a Muslim community that has lived and worked in the region for generations.

Hindu temples, gurdwaras, Buddhist temples and synagogues

The nearest dedicated temples, gurdwaras and synagogue are in Brisbane; see the Brisbane directory. Local Indian and Nepali associations celebrate Diwali and other festivals in Bundaberg.

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Bundy Asian & International Supermarket

Asian and international groceries in Bundaberg.

facebook.com/p/Bundy-Asian-International-Supermarket-61555621133363

Happy Family Asian Market

Asian supermarket in Bundaberg with groceries, sauces, noodles and frozen goods.

facebook.com/happyfamilyasianmarket

Bundy Halbe Asian Market

Asian grocery at 24 McLean Street, Bundaberg.

Brisbane's specialist grocers

For kosher food and a wider halal and South Asian range, Sunnybank and Kuraby on Brisbane's south side are the go-to; see the Brisbane directory.

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Woolworths

Supermarket chain with several Bundaberg stores, including at Hinkler Central; online ordering and delivery.

woolworths.com.au

Coles

Supermarket chain with several Bundaberg stores, including at Hinkler Central; online ordering and delivery.

coles.com.au

ALDI

Discount supermarket with stores in Bundaberg.

aldi.com.au

Hinkler Central

Bundaberg's largest shopping centre, at 16 Maryborough Street, with Coles, Woolworths, Kmart and more than sixty specialty stores.

Shalom Markets

Fresh produce, local food and handmade goods every Sunday from 6am to midday at Shalom College, 9 Fitzgerald Street.

SCHOOLS & UNIFORMS

Queensland Schools Directory

Find state schools, their catchments and contact details by address.

schoolsdirectory.eq.edu.au

DE International (Queensland Department of Education)

Enrolment conditions and fees for children on temporary visas, by visa subclass.

education.qld.gov.au

School uniforms

Each school sets its own uniform. Some Bundaberg schools sell through an on-site uniform shop; others use an online supplier (Bundaberg State High School, for example, uses Struddys, with pop-up fittings at the school). Ask your school when you enrol; many run second-hand uniform sales.

HOUSING & AREAS

realestate.com.au

Rental and sale listings for Bundaberg and the coast.

realestate.com.au

Domain

Rental and sale listings.

domain.com.au

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and shared houses, useful for a first few weeks.

flatmates.com.au

Residential Tenancies Authority (RTA)

Holds rental bonds in Queensland and explains tenants' rights and responsibilities.

rta.qld.gov.au

Tenants Queensland

Free advice for renters across Queensland.

1300 744 263 tenantsqld.org.au

Bundaberg Regional Council flood information

Flood mapping and property information worth checking for any address near the river or low-lying coast.

bundaberg.qld.gov.au

GETTING AROUND

Translink

Bundaberg city bus timetables and the Queensland journey planner.

13 12 30 translink.com.au

Queensland Government: overseas and interstate licences

How to convert an overseas driver licence in Queensland.

qld.gov.au/transport/licensing/driver-licensing/overseas

Queensland Rail Travel

Long-distance trains calling at Bundaberg: the Tilt Train (Brisbane–Rockhampton) and the Spirit of Queensland (Brisbane–Cairns).

queenslandrailtravel.com.au

COST COMPARISON LINKS

Numbeo: Bundaberg

Crowd-sourced cost-of-living comparisons with other cities.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Bundaberg

Australian Bureau of Statistics

Official data on prices, rents and the regional economy.

abs.gov.au

Bundaberg Regional Council community profile

Population, housing and household data for the Bundaberg region.

profile.id.com.au/bundaberg



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
[immi.homeaffairs.gov.au](https://www.immi.homeaffairs.gov.au)

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
[mara.gov.au](https://www.mara.gov.au)

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 [ahpra.gov.au](https://www.ahpra.gov.au)

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

MONEY & HOME

Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

SETTLING IN

TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Bundaberg. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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